

SuperValu Tidy Towns Entry Form 2026

We strongly recommend that you read the 2026 Tidy Towns Information Booklet available on www.tidytowns.ie before completing this form.

Section 1: About You!

Name of Town/Area/Village/Island	Two Mile Borris
Name of Town/Area/Village/Island (Irish)	Buirios Leith
County	Tipperary
Region	South East
Local Authority	Tipperary County Council
Last Year of Entry	2025
Organisation Name	Two Mile Borris Development and Tidy Towns
Contact Name	Andy Burns
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Estimated Location

Your adjudicator may not have visited your area before so please describe briefly where your town or village is located within your county, e.g. Xkm north/south etc. of the nearest large town, or give the road number along which your town is situated. Absolute clarity is of key importance.

Please do not exceed 100 words

Two Mile Borris is a small village on the N75 in mid-Tipperary, about 5 km east of Thurles and 1 km off the M8 motorway at Junction 5. It can also be approached from the old National road R639, which runs parallel to the M8 and passes through the nearby village of Littleton to the South and Urlingford to the North

Section 2: Population Category

Please tick your population category and enter your actual population (based on the latest census). If you are unsure, please check with the central statistics office, www.cso.ie or your Local Authority. Your adjudicator may check you have entered the correct category.

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Please enter your actual population here e.g. 19,999 **600**

Prize Category Population

Village - ☐ A (Under 200)	Large Town - ☐ E (5,001 to 10,000)
X Village - B (201 to 1,000)	Large Town - ☐ F (10,001 to 15,000)
Small Town - ☐ C (1,001 to 2,500)	Large Urban Centre - ☐ G (15,001 to 25,000)
Small Town - ☐ D (2,501 to 5,000)	Large Urban Centre - ☐ H (25,001 and over)

I understand and agree to be bound by the terms and conditions of the SuperValu Tidy Towns Competition and consent to the personal data contained in both my online submission and on this form being released to printers for the purpose of posting invitations, entry forms, results books or other documentation for the purpose of administering the SuperValu Tidy Towns Competition and other related initiatives. I also consent to this data being released to the Tidy Towns Adjudicators as part of the Entry Form upon which our adjudication is based. I understand that the printers contracted to carry out this work will be advised that all data should be deleted once the specific task has been completed. I understand that Personal Data provided in this form will be retained by the Department for a period of 3 years for the distribution of entry forms and information directly related to the competition.

The Freedom of Information body undertakes to use its best endeavors to hold confidential, any information provided by you in this form, subject to the organisation's obligations under law, including the Freedom of Information Act 2014. Should you wish that any of the information supplied by you in this form should not be disclosed because of its sensitivity, you should, when providing the information, identify the same and specify the reasons for its sensitivity.

I understand that I can withdraw my consent at any time to this information being stored or used in this way by writing to the Tidy Towns Unit stating I am withdrawing my consent.

Signed (on behalf of entrant): **Andy Burns** Date: **09/05/2026**

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Community - Your Planning and Involvement

80 Marks



Number involved in your Committee: 15

Number not on committee but who volunteer: 25

Please indicate level of voluntary commitment (number of Tidy Towns meetings, community meetings, general involvement of the community, new residents, etc.):

The committee itself meets twice a year in early Spring and late Summer.

A steady core of around 15 supplemented by the 40 plus network. The 2026 set-pieces were:

- Four consecutive Thursday clean-ups in April (covered in Section 6)
- The Sensory Garden timber blitz (Project 018)
- The living-willow re-weave (Project 048)
- The village-wide planter watering rota
- The year-round mutt-mitt round
- Ongoing planter maintenance

Split the Pot. Our weekly Split the Pot charity lottery runs jointly across five village volunteer groups: TMB Tidy Towns, TMB Development Group, the Parents Association, the Defibrillator Group, and the Christmas Lights Committee. Auto-renewing subscriptions are €2 per week, with cash entries also accepted at the pubs and shop. Proceeds are split evenly between the five groups and the weekly winning ticket. It gives all five groups predictable unrestricted income while keeping the village's volunteer effort intentionally connected. In 2026 the draw delivered €7,200 to TMB Tidy Towns, up on 2025.

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Joan's Wellie Walk and Auction (St Stephen's Day 2025). One of the village's biggest community days. The 2025 walk and Monster Auction was held in memory of committee member Joan O'Dwyer, who passed in 2024, and raised funds for the Christmas Lights Committee. Registration at 11am, auction following the walk - the kind of event that channels takings straight into something the whole village sees.

Graveyard extension. TMB Tidy Towns put €1,000 of our own funding into the new graveyard extension alongside the Graveyard Committee. We attended planning meetings through 2024 and 2025, and were on the ground for the Turning of the Sod in February 2025. The new entrance stonework was completed during the year, a real lift for that side of the village (photographs in the appendix). With the build done we are now looking ahead to the planting phase with the Graveyard Committee, Father Tom and Biodiversity Officer Ann-Marie Fleming.

Please list all the agencies, bodies and businesses that have supported your activities through sponsorship, resources, funding, advice, etc.):

Tipperary County Council and elected representatives:

- Heritage Officer Róisín O Grady
- Biodiversity Officer Ann-Marie Fleming
- Thurles Municipal District Roads section, with District Director Mark Connolly
- Cllr Sean Ryan (instrumental on the Bog Walk LEADER grant)

School and parish:

- Two Mile Borris NS - Mr McCullagh, Joann Cussen (Green Schools lead)
- St James Parish - Father Tom

Funders and development bodies:

- North Tipperary LEADER Partnership / NTDC (Lorraine McKeogh; LEADER grant for Bog Walk Phase 1)
- MBB Community Development DSP CE Scheme

Village volunteer groups we work alongside:

- Moycarkey Borris GAA
- TMB Christmas Lights Committee
- Thurles Lions Club
- TMB Vintage Club
- Graveyard Committee
- TMB Parents Association
- TMB Defib Group

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Local business support:

- SMJ Construction (Seanie M)
- Village pubs and shop: Bannon's, Tully's, Corcoran's

Others:

- National Museum of Ireland (Offered advice on Heritage details for the new website)

How do you communicate with your community (newsletter, newspapers, public meetings, email, social media, website, etc.)?

- New Tidy Towns site: <https://aburnsy.github.io/tidytowns/>
- In future, we will use new TMB Tidy Towns Instagram [@twomileborristidytowns](#) ([Project 043](#))
- Village WhatsApp groups (1 for each of the official groups)
- Residents-association group chats (committee members on most)
- School Parents Association comms app (committee parents post)
- Parish leaflet (St James)
- Tipperary Star newspaper (for larger announcements only)
- Sunday Split the Pot draws - live-streamed always

Worked example, April 2026 Community Litter Pick: one flyer pushed across all of the above on the same day, with live-streamed announcements on preceding draws. Turnout across the four Thursdays reflected that reach - the village core covered by a regular crew, the approach roads carried by villagers who came in off the residents-association and Parents Association notices.

New Tidy Towns Site with project tracker, heritage pages and 5-year plan (2026 build)

One of the bigger pieces of new 2026 community work, (which helps massively with our communication), and one we are properly proud of: the [Tidy Towns site](#), built fresh this year. It does the job of several things at once:

- **Live record of every project** (active, completed and on the future register) with status, costs, benefit rating and photographs
- **Our formal 3-to-5-year plan** - the live site itself is the plan, rather than a separate static document that goes stale the day it is printed
- **Village heritage record** - the [heritage pages](#) walk from Bronze Age to Modern, drawing on the M8 motorway-build excavations and our own research; coverage takes in the seventh-century monastery at [Liathmore](#), the Norman [castle](#) on the western approach, the medieval Anglo-Norman borough with its watermill, malting kilns and silver-coin hoard, and the [1900 All-Ireland Hurling win](#) commemorated by the village-centre monument
- [Interactive village map](#) with markers and photographs for every named site

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- **Full village planting list** with species and locations across the village core, residential estates and approach roads

It is a properly cross-village effort. Contributors include:

- **Réidín Corbet**- photographs throughout the site
- **Sinead Carey** - event detail and historical record
- **Mr McCullagh and Joann Cussen** on the school side - Green Schools, the Sensory Garden as outdoor classroom, the school's 1846 plaque
- **Villagers across the parish** for the heritage write-ups, drawing on family knowledge and local research as well as the M8 archaeology

Each section of the printed application below opens with direct links into the relevant part of the tracker. Project status, new photographs and any work that lands after submission stay current on the live site, so the adjudicator (and anyone else interested) can see what is actually happening rather than what was true on the day this snapshot was printed. The printable snapshot of the tracker itself is attachment 2. Please note that we do expect to migrate this content to a new URL next year and/or incorporate it into the main village website.

How do you engage with your local schools, youth clubs, etc.? How do you involve youth in your work? Do you have Junior Tidy Towns? Is there youth representation on your committee.

Two Mile Borris NS (Scoil Mochaomhóg Naofa NS) sits directly beside the Sensory Garden, which doubles as the school's outdoor classroom. Teacher Joann Cussen leads the school's 8th Green Flag (the 2026 theme is Global Citizenship Marine); past flags continue.

2026 school activity includes:

- National Spring Clean (8 years and counting)
- Clean Up Tipp Term 1, with termly picks going forward
- Picker Pals home-rotation kit
- Battery recycling drive across the village pubs and shops
- Raised-bed gardening
- Active travel via the An Taisce bike shed

Our committee contribution is structural rather than programmatic: keeping the Sensory Garden ready for daily school use (Projects **018** and **048**), maintaining the village planter at the school's 1846 plaque, and running our village-edge clean-ups in parallel with the school's own. The after-school programme also uses the Sensory Garden, and committee members bring their own children along on litter picks.

We do not currently have Junior Tidy Towns or formal youth representation; in practice, the school is our youth partner. Full Green Schools narrative is in Section 4.

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Briefly identify ONE specific project where particular effort was applied since May 10th 2025. (This can include ongoing maintenance work or new project)

The autumn 2025 **11,100-bulb planting programme**, jointly delivered with three residents' associations.

This was the largest single planting effort the village has done in living memory. The mix:

- 1,600 Dutch Master daffodils
- 1,000 Purple Sensation alliums
- 1,000 Nigrum alliums
- 5,000 Ruby Giant crocus
- 2,500 Drumstick alliums

The total invoice was €1,143.51, deliberately structured as a shared cost so that three residents' associations carried part of the spend rather than the committee carrying the lot. That made it a properly joint project. The TMB share with delivery was roughly €320 inc VAT.

Locations were chosen so the spring display belongs to the village as a whole:

- The village seating area on the Thurles approach. The existing roadside bench is now framed by alliums and Ruby Giant crocuses; this is the most dramatic single image in this submission.
- The N75 west approach
- The L4202 east approach outside Leighton Manor
- The Cluain Na Seimre entrance green on the Ballyduff Road
- The Glen Carraig limestone wall
- Multiple front gardens and a small green inside Ardleigh

Crocus and daffodils carried the spring display from late February through April; alliums took over from May into July. The photo appendix is built around that springtime evidence.

Sharing the cost with the residents' associations brought them in as proper partners with a stake in the result. We expect that model to carry in future years and to deepen the village-wide spread each year.

Approximately how many years has your community entered the competition. How has your community benefited from involvement in the competition?

First entered 2013, ran 2013 to 2019, then returned 2024. 2026 is therefore our third year back. The discipline of the annual entry, and especially the adjudicator's category-by-category report, gives us a clear external read on what is working.

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The 2025 adjudicator's report shaped most of our 2026 work programme: every numbered recommendation has a project file on the [tracker](#), and the Sections below walk through what we did against each of them.

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Streetscape & Public Places

80 Marks

Project pages, photographs and the village map all sit on the public tracker. The streetscape is anchored at the centre by the **All-Ireland Victory Centennial monument** marking the 1900 hurling championship; Our village background is on our **heritage pages**.

Bollards repaint at the monument (Project 013, addresses rec #3 carried from 2024)

Scheduled for May 2026, ahead of adjudication. Baseline photographs are on file and the post-repaint record will land on **Project 013**.

Cohesive village-wide planter scheme (Project 012, addresses rec #4)

Local tradesman Seamus Butler builds our blue trough planters, mostly from salvaged timber and otherwise from locally-sourced wood. They anchor:

- The cemetery layby
- The Meadow Brook entrance
- The former Dempsey and Harold Motors site
- The school's 1846 plaque on the L4202

Leighton Manor Estate has commissioned two more for inside the estate (covered in later section). End-of-life plastic planters at o the main street are replaced as they fail, rather than ripped out for the sake of it. Ann-Marie D leads the village watering rota across the whole set. The AIPP-listed perennial mix is detailed in Section 3 and in the species note (attachment 4). Tracked on **Project 012**.

Derelict on the L4202 opposite the cemetery (addresses rec #1)

A formal report has been lodged with Tipperary County Council's Town Regeneration / Derelict Sites team in May 2026. It covers two issues:

1. **Footpath safety** - mature copper beech, hawthorn and self-seeded growth are forcing pedestrians visiting the cemetery into the road
2. **Visual amenity** - the building is a poor first impression on the cemetery approach

Photographs are in the appendix.

Forge as a working village asset, and the replica window (Project 022, addresses rec #2)

The forge beside the church serves year-round as committee storage and each December as the village Christmas crib. The Christmas Lights Committee, with our backing, has installed memorial plaques and a seat outside (and a second plaque inside) for past members. The grit-surfaced parking and shrub border opposite (work done in 2024 to 2025) still look well.

Heritage Officer Róisín O Grady was contacted on 8 May 2026 on two related questions: the forge's curtilage relative to St James RC Church (TRPS840), and Built Heritage Investment

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Scheme 2026 eligibility. Her guidance will shape a costed 2027 proposal and a **BHIS application** in the July 2026 round if eligible.

Two main-street private-sector changes - welcomed not claimed

Two pieces of welcome streetscape progress have happened in 2026 independent of the committee:

1. **SMJ Construction (Seanie Mockler)** is refurbishing two main-street derelicts: new slate roofs, render and sash-style windows. Planning was submitted independently before any adjudicator commentary.
2. **Roadvacs (Irl) Limited** has taken on the long-standing Dempsey and Harold Motors site as their Tipperary base, around April 2026.

Both lift the streetscape independent of any committee action and we are pleased to see them happening. With both the derelicts and the Dempsey frontage now under proper refurbishment, window boxes on hoarded openings (rec #1) would be cosmetic theatre on top of better work; not the right intervention for 2026.

Eastern bookend - Two-Mile-Borris Transport Museum

Eamonn Medley's **Transport Museum** opens by arrangement for car shows, coffee mornings and community fundraisers (Eamonn is also heavily involved in Thurles Lions Club). The newest addition is a full train and a stretch of track rescued from the retired Bord na Móna bog at Littleton.

Power-washing, church railings, street furniture

Power-washing runs as-needed across the village core. A welcome 2026 contribution from outside committee work was the cleaning and repainting of the St James church railings across from the monument, with credit to Father Tom. Benches, signage, planters, council bottle banks and the small bins at Tully's and Corcoran's frontages were all audited under the 2026 photo programme; nothing has needed council escalation.

Looking ahead to 2027

- Routine maintenance of the planter scheme and street furniture
- The forge replica window becomes a 2027 flagship (**Project 022**) if Heritage Officer guidance and a BHIS award land
- "Slán Abhaile" lettering on the back of the welcome signs (**Project 039**) planned for 2027

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Green Spaces and Landscaping

80 Marks

The **full village planting list**, with species, locations and photographs, sits on the public tracker.

Autumn 2025 to spring 2026 bulb programme (Project 047, completed)

11,100 bulbs were planted in autumn 2025 with three residents' associations and TMB Tidy Towns volunteers. The mix:

- 1,600 Dutch Master daffodils
- 1,000 Purple Sensation alliums
- 1,000 Nigrum alliums
- 5,000 Ruby Giant crocus
- 2,500 Drumstick alliums

The total invoice was €1,143.51, shared between TMB Tidy Towns and three participating estates. The committee share including delivery was roughly €320 inc VAT. Volunteers on the planting day included Peter N, Kieran O'D, John McC, Rory, Amy, Noel, Tanya, Chloe and Cathal.

Locations were chosen so the spring display belongs to the village as a whole:

- The village seating area on the Thurles approach. The existing roadside bench is now framed by alliums and Ruby Giant crocuses; this is the most dramatic single image in this submission.
- The N75 west approach
- The L4202 east approach outside Leighton Manor
- The Cluain Na Seimre entrance green on the Ballyduff Road
- The Glen Carraig limestone wall
- Multiple front gardens and a small green inside Ardleigh

Crocus and daffodils carried the spring display from late February through April; alliums took over from May into July. Full record on **Project 047**.

Cohesive village-wide pollinator planter scheme (Project 012, addresses rec #4)

Selection criteria, in priority order:

1. **Pollinator value first** - every variety on the All-Ireland Pollinator Plan list
2. **Clump-forming** - so we can divide our own stock between beds rather than buy fresh annuals each year
3. **Long flowering** - March to October
4. **Hardy** - for full sun, free-draining roadside soil and occasional salt spray
5. **Simple open flowers** - short-tongued bees can access them (no doubles or highly-bred cultivars)

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6. Red and yellow as core colours - picking up the village flag colours visible on the GAA monument

The six-variety mix that resulted:

- **Mrs Bradshaw geum** - scarlet ruffled doubles
- **Coronation Gold yarrow** - flat yellow plates
- **Prima Ruby echinacea** - late-summer cones
- **East Friesland salvia** - deep blue-purple bumblebee spikes
- **Red valerian** - soft pinky-red panicles
- **Tufted Hair Grass** - airy golden seed plumes for structure

Full planting and species note is attached as attachment 4. Tracked on [Project 012](#).

Unmown wildflower bed at St James Church grounds (rec #5)

Already in place at the church grounds. Formal AIPP management - signage, dock and thistle removal cycle, autumn cut-and-remove - would follow if the parish takes up *Returning to Nature* (covered in Section 4). The May 2026 conversation with Father Tom opens that multi-year work, tracked on [Project 045](#).

Sensory Garden 2026 timber maintenance blitz (Project 018, addresses rec #6)

In spring 2026, Michael Maher applied two coats of protective oil across all the timber, repaired damaged elements with locally-sourced wood, and cleaned up the gravel paths. Patrick H rewove the living-willow gateway in March 2026 ([Project 048](#)). The garden is in daily use as the school's outdoor classroom (see Section 4). .

Routine green-space work in committee-controlled beds

Our beds are managed by hand-weeding and by timing rather than by chemical treatment. The wider village ground-maintenance round (a contractor funded by a council grant) still uses chemical herbicides on hard surfaces. Section 5 sets out [Project 040](#), the multi-year ambition to move the village off chemical weed management by 2030.

Looking ahead to 2027

- Continue the species transition in planters and beds
- Reassess the autumn 2027 bulb planting to cover any locations not yet reached
- If the parish takes up *Returning to Nature*, formal AIPP management of the church-grounds wildflower bed begins
- The autumn 2026 [kids' kitchen garden bed](#) (Project 024, onions and garlic) lifts in early summer 2027 and may be expanded if it lands well

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Nature and Biodiversity in your locality

80 Marks

The **Bog Walk habitat description**, the *Returning to Nature* framing and the Green Schools activity all sit on the **public tracker**.

Bog Walk Loop, 6.5 km (Project 028 Phase 1)

The Bog Walk has two access points into the village:

- **Clover entrance** on the main street
- **Clover Lane** off the Ballyduff Road

The route crosses raised bog, dry heath that turns purple with heather in August, wet meadow and regenerating woodland. The full habitat write-up, plant and bird lists, including the carnivorous Round-leaved Sundew and Ireland's native Red Squirrel, is on **Project 028**.

Phase 1 (Ballyduff side) scope:

- Clearance of overhanging branches
- Scrub and hedge cutback
- Stone base course
- Removable bollards or boulders at access points

Tidy Towns is paying upfront at a budgeted €7,000, our largest single capital commitment in 2026. A LEADER grant covers the majority of that; Cllr Sean Ryan was instrumental in landing it. Once recouped, the money rolls into Phase 2 (proper surfacing for accessibility), with a second LEADER round to be applied for in 2027. Phase 1 begins only when nesting season ends.

Returning to Nature conversation with St James parish (Project 045)

Returning to Nature is the Irish Catholic Bishops' Conference programme committing parishes to managing 30% of their church grounds primarily for nature by 2030.

Early conversations open in May 2026 with Father Tom; the parish makes the call. Joining would place the existing unmown wildflower bed and bug hotel within a recognised national initiative, and would give us access to the Faith Community Pollinator Plan and the FIT-count methodology.

If the parish agrees, the next steps are: Biodiversity Officer guidance, a first FIT count, and possible school involvement via Joann Cussen. Tracked on **Project 045**.

Sensory Garden habitat features

Two deliberate habitat features built into the garden's daily layout:

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- Decaying log piles between the beds for insect life
- Bird boxes around the garden edge for nesting cover

Old Road Triangle - deliberate non-intervention

A patch of mature woodland and rough ground between the L4202 and the N75, left untouched since the through-road was diverted in 2010 (M8 J5). No mowing, no tidying, no lifting of fallen wood.

Year-round birdlife includes summer migrant warblers (blackcap, chiffchaff) and goldcrest. That alone is evidence that minimal intervention is the right policy here. Full bird list on the [Old Road Triangle place page](#).

Graveyard biodiversity, and Biodiversity Officer outreach (Project 019, addresses rec #9)

Ann-Marie Fleming was contacted directly in April 2026; an on-site walk-about is hoped for over summer 2026, covering the church grounds, the cemetery and ideally the Bog Walk. We are building a multi-year working relationship rather than a one-off engagement.

The graveyard scheme is being scoped with Ann-Marie's input intended to shape the design, with a parallel conversation with Father Tom in train. Targeted as a 2027 grant-funded project. Tracked on [Project 019](#).

Two Mile Borris NS Green Schools (addresses rec #7)

Teacher Joann Cussen leads the school's 8th Green Flag (the 2026 theme is Global Citizenship Marine); past flags continue. 2026 activity includes:

- National Spring Clean (8 years and counting)
- Clean Up Tipp Term 1, with termly picks going forward
- Picker Pals home-rotation kit
- Battery recycling drive across the village pubs and shops
- Raised-bed gardening
- Active travel via the An Taisce bike shed

Our committee support is structural: keeping the Sensory Garden ready as the school's outdoor classroom (Projects 018 and 048), maintaining the village planter at the school's 1846 plaque, and running village-edge clean-ups in parallel with the school's own.

Tree planting (addresses rec #8) - consciously not taken on as a new scheme

The village core is already tree-rich; protecting what is in place matters more than adding for the sake of it. The mature canopy on village land includes Sycamores, Rowan, Whitethorn,

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Silver Birch, Whitebeam, Copper Beech, Cypress, Willow, Ash, Alder and Hazel coppice. Full breakdown by location is on the [planting list](#).

New native planting does make biodiversity sense at the cemetery extension, where species and layout will be planned with Ann-Marie Fleming under [Project 019](#). Hedgerow management on village-controlled land follows AIPP guidance: no cuts March to August.

Looking ahead to 2027

- Continue the *Returning to Nature* parish conversation
- Deliver the graveyard scheme if the grant lands
- Apply for a second LEADER round for Bog Walk Phase 2
- Record species on any unmown verges that go in (see Section 8)

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Sustainability - Doing more with less

80 Marks

Water butts (Project 010, addresses rec #10)

A large water butt has been in active use at the Sensory Garden for some years. It is the backbone of our rainwater capture, drawn on through the season by the watering team and a working demonstration for the school children using the garden as their outdoor classroom.

Beyond that, several volunteers (Eileen C at Meadow Brook is a regular) top up the blue trough planters from their home water butts. Honest assessment: not ideal, but some planters are too far away from any public buildings, so to have rain-water harvesting in those locations is unlikely.

The next candidate is the cast-iron downpipe at the corner of St James Church. Because the church is on the Record of Protected Structures (TRPS840), installation needs Heritage Officer sign-off; a question is currently in with Róisín O Grady alongside the forge query (Section 2). We have no hanging baskets, so harvested water serves trough planters and in-ground beds. Full record on [Project 010](#).

Composting (addresses rec #11)

A compost bin has been running at the Sensory Garden since the garden first opened. Long-standing, not a 2026 installation. Almost all the garden waste goes through it; some grass cuttings are deliberately taken away to keep the carbon-to-nitrogen balance right and the bin producing usable compost rather than a wet anaerobic mess. The compost is re-used in the blue trough planters and in the garden's own beds. Our 2026 contribution against this recommendation is to write the practice down properly.

Textile recycling, school-led collection drives

The council removed the clothes bank at the church gate (the nearest is now in Cashel). In its place, the school Parents Association runs twice-yearly clothes-collection drives, with residents dropping bags at the school and the proceeds going to school activities. We help publicise each round and support directly through committee parents.

Litter segregation pilot (April 2026, addresses rec #12)

Across four weekly clean-ups, bottles, cans and clean recyclables went into one set of bags, and the rest into another. Honest finding: most kerbside litter was too contaminated for the recycling stream, but bottles and cans in good condition are now reliably diverted from landfill. Standard practice at our clean-ups going forward.

Chemical-free weed management ambition by 2030 (Project 040, multi-year)

Brought to you by the Department of Rural and Community Development and the Gaeltacht

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The committee receives a council grant and uses it to fund a local contractor for the village ground-maintenance round. The contractor's standard practice includes chemical weed treatment on hard surfaces. Our own beds and planters have shifted to hand-weeding and to cutting before seed-set, but the contractor round remains chemical-based. Pretending otherwise would not stand up to scrutiny.

The 2030 ambition is a village moved away from chemical weed management entirely. The path is deliberately gradual; an abrupt ban would push people off Tidy Towns rather than bring them with us. In 2026 we are:

1. Documenting the current position honestly
2. Scouting alternatives - hot-water weeding, mechanical brushing, vinegar treatments, edge redesign and mowing-height changes
3. Opening contractor and council conversations

Tracked on [Project 040](#).

Community EV charging at the pump house (Project 036, 2027 ambition)

The pump house is expected to decommission in the near future, and three-phase power already runs to the site. That is the supply needed for a fast charger.

Funding routes for community-scale charging include:

- SEAI Community Grant
- Various ZEVI charging schemes
- Tipperary County Council Climate Action funds

Gated on decommissioning and confirmed funding, so this is a 2027 ambition rather than a 2026 deliverable. Tracked on [Project 036](#).

Pot platform idea (planned for 2027)

One we are genuinely excited about for next year. The village has accumulated a mix of plastic pots over the years - different shapes, sizes, materials, all still serviceable but visually mismatched when sat next to each other on the streetscape. Rather than throw any of them out, the idea is to build a simple shared platform (locally-made wood, in keeping with the blue trough planter scheme) that holds the existing pots together as one cohesive display.

Three things it gets us at once:

1. **Sustainability** - we keep reusing what we already own rather than sending serviceable pots to landfill and buying new
2. **Biodiversity** - the planting in those pots sticks to the same AIPP-listed perennial mix as the rest of the village scheme (Section 3)

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3. **Streetscape** - the platform unifies the visual at a distance, so what currently reads as a jumble reads instead as a deliberate cluster

Planned as 2027 work; we will scope sites, materials and cost over the autumn and winter and report on [project 053](#) as it firms up.

Looking ahead to 2027

- Scout additional water-butt sites
- Embed segregation across all clean-ups
- Deliver Project 036 if the pump house decommissions and a funding route confirms
- Continue Project 040 with priced alternatives and a contractor conversation by year-end
- Deliver project 053

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Tidiness and Litter Control

90 Marks

Tidiness is the area where the committee has the most consistent year-round effort.

Four April 2026 clean-ups (Project 001, with rec #12 segregation)

Run on consecutive Thursdays through the village core and out along the four approach roads. Promoted on a single flyer (working copy in the photo appendix), pushed across:

- The Parents Association comms app
- The residents-association group chats
- Village WhatsApp groups
- The TMB Split-the-Pot Instagram account
- Direct email

Turnout was broad rather than committee-only. Among others across the month: Anne-Marie, Kieran, Aidan, Brian, Michelle, David, Dave, Declan, John, Karen, Pat, Maeve, Michael, Billy, Paddy and Tom. The breadth came directly from the multi-channel notice; villagers came in off the residents-association chats and the Parents Association app who would not have heard about it through committee channels alone.

The village core itself is everyday bits and pieces. The approach roads are different - illegal dumping is a sad regular occurrence and 2026 was no exception.

April 2026 was also the first time we ran clean-ups with point-of-collection segregation of recyclables (rec #12, also covered in Section 5). Honest finding: most kerbside litter is too contaminated for recycling, but bottles and cans in good condition are now reliably diverted from landfill. Standard practice going forward. Full record on [Project 001](#).

Bollards repaint at the monument (Project 013, addresses rec #14 carried from 2024)

Scheduled for May 2026 ahead of adjudication. Baseline photographs are on file. Post-repaint record will land on [Project 013](#). Same action as Streetscape rec #3.

Mutt-mitt dispenser at the monument (Project 005, addresses rec #13)

Found empty during the 2025 adjudication; back on the volunteer round and now refilled by Michelle M when stock is in. Cllr Sean Ryan has offered to pull a larger stockpile from Clonmel to keep the dispenser reliably full. Full record on [Project 005](#).

Dog-fouling control

Three things working together:

1. The mutt-mitt dispenser at the monument

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2. The volunteer round
3. The wider village habit around the Bog Walk and core

Anti-dog-fouling stencils in white paint at intervals along village footpaths complement the dispenser. Heavy traffic has worn some through and we will refresh those stretches in 2026.

Public bins

There are no general public litter bins on the main street. Collection is handled by household waste contracts, with the council's glass bottle banks and the small private bins at Tully's and Corcoran's frontages serving on-the-day disposal. All audited under the 2026 photo programme; nothing has needed council escalation.

Looking ahead to 2027

- Continuity: volunteer round on the dispenser, bollards repainted as needed, segregation carried forward
- Consider an annual themed clean-up (e.g. Bog Walk litter sweep) to give the routine a visible annual rhythm

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Residential Streets & Housing Areas

55 Marks

There are nine named estates in the village:

- Castle Park
- Ned Hayes Park
- Glen Carraig
- Cluain Na Seimre
- Fanning Park
- Dún Na Rí
- Ardleigh
- Leighton Manor
- Meadow Brook

Our role is to encourage and support residents' own efforts rather than take over maintenance of any individual estate. Estates with specific 2026 activity are below; Castle Park, Fanning Park and Dún Na Rí had no estate-specific highlights in 2026.

Ned Hayes Park (addresses rec #15) - consciously not taken on

The 2025 adjudicator recommended bedding plants in green strips and climbers on walls. Set against our 2026 funding priorities (Bog Walk, Sensory Garden timber, the kids' kitchen garden, planter maintenance), the committee has chosen not to take on new bedding-and-climbers at Ned Hayes Park in 2026 and possibly 2027.

Strategic preference: residential effort focused on managed-for-wildlife around estate boundaries (winter wildlife strips, unmown verges) rather than conventional bedding inside one estate. The existing young Silver Birch and back-boundary shrub layer continue to bed in.

A small note: the 2025 report used "Noel Hayes Park"; the estate is in fact **Ned Hayes Park**, named after Ned Hayes, captain of the 1900 All-Ireland-winning village team.

Glen Carraig (Project 016, addresses rec #16) - asked, ball is with the estate

The committee asked the estate in 2026 whether they would designate an unmown wildflower area at the entrance green. The estate manages the green; they are still researching and the call is theirs.

The estate already carries part of the spring bulb display along its limestone wall: crocus, daffodil and allium planted in autumn 2025. Tracked on **Project 016**.

Cluain Na Seimre (Ballyduff Road)

1,500 Ruby Giant crocuses planted in the green at the estate entrance as part of the autumn 2025 bulb programme; the first burst of colour on the north approach in March 2026. The

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mature conifer boundary hedge with a flowering pink Weigela on the corner gives year-round shelter for nesting birds.

Ardleigh

About 1,500 autumn 2025 bulbs were planted across front gardens and a small green inside the estate, with residents picking up the planting effort directly.

Leighton Manor Estate

A new roadside wildflower strip with allium bulbs (Purple Sensation and Nigrum) planted within it (Project 047). The estate has commissioned two new wooden planters from Seamus Butler, the same tradesman who builds the village's whole set, mostly from salvaged timber. Awaiting delivery; planting will wait until autumn to avoid midsummer establishment risk, keeping the estate aligned with the village-wide scheme.

Meadow Brook

New cohesive blue trough planters at the entrance and junction, matching the village-wide locally-made wooden planter scheme. The Copper Beech avenue inside the wall remains the estate's signature feature.

Winter wildlife strips across the estates (multi-year ask)

We have written to most estates with sufficient green space, and to Tipperary County Council (who mow many estate greens), proposing one section per estate left unmown from late summer through winter. The rationale:

- Seed-heads feed birds
- Dead stems shelter overwintering insects
- Unmown strips benefit pollinators

The proposal is for one early-spring cut and "managed for wildlife" signage so that the intent reads as deliberate biodiversity rather than neglect. For now, just Leighton Manor have agreed, though others have yet to meet as a Residents Association to formally accept or reject. This is a multi-year piece tied to council mowing and resident agreement.

Garden competition (addresses rec #17)

On the **future register** as a "when capacity allows" idea. May move to active in 2027.

Looking ahead to 2027

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- Designate winter wildlife strips in any estate that comes back positively
- If Glen Carraig agrees, deliver the wildflower area at the entrance green
- Plant up Leighton Manor's wooden planters in autumn 2027 once delivered
- Consider activating the garden competition if capacity allows

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Approach Roads, Streets & Lanes

55 Marks

The **interactive village map** shows the four approaches and the Bog Walk's two access points.

Two Mile Borris is approached by four main roads. The L4202 runs inside the village, so the west and south approaches are both the N75 at different ends.

The four approaches

West, N75 from Thurles - the busiest approach and the main visitor arrival route. Spring 2026 Dutch Master daffodils along a stretch give a strong gateway display through March (photographs in the appendix).

South, N75 from the M8 (Junction 5) and Dublin - the highest through-traffic of any approach. Verges are mown by Tipperary County Council Roads under a TII grant. The committee opened a Roads channel on 8 May 2026 on verge mowing cadence and a pollinator-friendly approach to the M8-exit roundabout (**Project 046**). The Black River bridge sits just south, with a good corridor of native willow, alder, hawthorn, blackthorn and gorse on the banks.

North, Ballyduff Road - quiet rural approach with a row of mature deciduous trees. 1,500 Ruby Giant crocuses planted at the Cluain Na Seimre entrance green (autumn 2025); first burst of colour on this approach in March 2026.

East, L4202 from the Turnpike (Littleton / Urlingford) - welcome sign on a gabion-stone plinth in front of a trimmed hedgerow. About 100 Dutch Master daffodils and 200 alliums were planted outside Leighton Manor in autumn 2025. Both varieties are vigorous and naturalise readily.

Unmown verge strip proposal (Project 009, addresses rec #18)

Verge maintenance on the N75 is carried out by Tipperary County Council Roads under a TII grant; the committee does not control the mowing operation.

To advance this proposal we have opened two complementary council channels:

1. **Biodiversity Officer Ann-Marie Fleming** in April 2026, for the biodiversity rationale
2. **Thurles Municipal District Roads section** in May 2026, via the council's customer-services route, with District Director Mark Connolly cc'd, for the operational conversation

We see this as a multi-year relationship, not an enforcement exercise.

Our policy preference, in line with AIPP grassland guidance, is:

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- No sown commercial seed (let the existing seed bank emerge)
- End-of-season cut-and-remove
- "Managed for wildlife" signage on agreed strips

None of those steps is in place yet - they follow once Roads lands. At no cost to TMB; reduces the council's mowing burden. Tracked on [Project 009](#).

Welcome signage

Audited on each approach as part of the photography programme; nothing flagged in 2026 has needed council escalation. "Slán Abhaile" lettering on the back of welcome signs ([Project 039](#)) is planned for 2027.

Litter on approach roads

Covered in the April 2026 four-week clean-up programme (Section 6), working from the village boundary inward on each approach. Hedgerow management on the approaches is mostly outside the committee's direct control, falling between Roads and individual landowners.

Bog Walk Loop, 6.5 km

Ties into the village at both ends:

- **Clover entrance** on the main street
- **Clover Lane** off the Ballyduff Road approach at the north end

Visitors arriving via Ballyduff Road pass the loop's northern entry before reaching the village proper. The biodiversity narrative and the LEADER-funded Phase 1 works are in Section 4: [Project 028](#).

Looking ahead to 2027

- If Roads lands positively, the first unmown verge strips and "managed for wildlife" signage go in during 2027 with the autumn cut-and-remove cycle following
- Record species seen as the strips establish
- Project 039 added to welcome signs
- Consider whether one approach is a candidate for small-scale gateway pollinator planting under AIPP

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Mapping your town or village

An A4 map forms one of the attachments to our application.

Please see our interactive version of the same map, complete with photos of the sites-of-interest and more information on each [here](#).

Please draw or attach a sketched or printed map of your town/village/area with street and place names and prominent landmarks. The locations of your new work for this year's competition should also be marked. Ensure each project is clearly listed in the legend.

Please refer to the 2026 SuperValu TidyTowns Information Booklet available on www.tidytowns.ie

Please note the following advice.

- A hand-drawn map is perfectly acceptable if a formal printed map is not available or suitable.
- Map should be a manageable size, A4 or A3 depending on the layout of your town or village.
- Please name priority streets/roads as necessary and mark the key public buildings/landmarks.
- You are advised not to use Google mapping.
- You may find Ordnance Survey Ireland Urban (or Rural as applicable) 'Place' Maps most useful.
- Examples of effective maps can be found at www.tidytowns.ie in addition to A4 and A3 map graph templates.
- A clear legend is essential; please ensure that a unique numbering sequence is applied.

Tips on Completing this form:

- Be mindful of the volume of material you submit, the Adjudicator has limited time to review your work during their adjudication so it should be presented in a clear and concise manner.
- Please ensure you have included a map of your area and your TidyTowns 3/5-year plan with your entry. You can upload these with your completed entry form on the TidyTowns website – you will not be able to register your entry without a map.
- You can also upload photographs to accompany your entry form
- Don't forget to enter our Special Awards, information can be found on www.tidytowns.ie

To enter the competition, please go to -
<https://competition.tidytowns.ie/> and follow the link to register
and upload your entry form by Monday 11th May 2026

Best of Luck!

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Photograph Appendix

Photographs supporting the 2026 entry-form sections, arranged 4 per A4 page. Each photo is titled with the relevant section number(s) and project reference so the adjudicator can match the visual to the narrative.



Cover - Two Mile Borris from the air, spring 2025 (village core, school and Sensory Garden centre frame)



Section 2 - All-Ireland Victory Centennial monument with the 2026 flower bed in the foreground



Section 2 / Project 012 - Close-up of the monument flower bed in full bloom, May 2026



Section 2 / Project 012 - Cohesive blue trough planters at the cemetery parking layby

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*Section 1 - New graveyard entrance stonework, completed 2025
(committee contributed EUR1,000 and attended Turning of the Sod,
February 2025)*



*Section 2 / rec #1 - Derelict property on the L4202 opposite the
cemetery; formal report submitted to the council in May 2026*



*Section 1 / Section 3 / Project 047 - Allium and crocus display
framing the village seating area, May 2026 (the lead
bulb-programme image)*

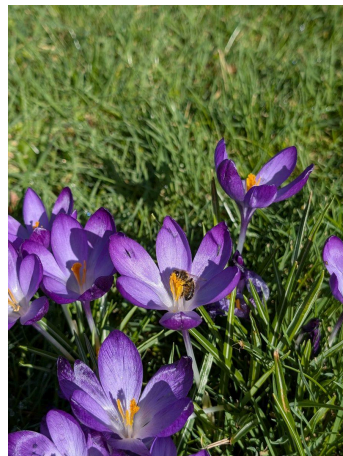


*Sections 3, 8 / Project 047 - Dutch Master daffodils on the N75 west
approach, spring 2026*

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Sections 3, 7, 8 / Project 047 - 1,500 Ruby Giant crocuses at the Cluain Na Seimre entrance green, March 2026



Sections 3, 7 / Project 047 - Honeybee on a Ruby Giant crocus at Glen Carraig, spring 2026



Sections 3, 7 / Project 047 - Dutch Master daffodils along the Glen Carraig limestone wall, spring 2026

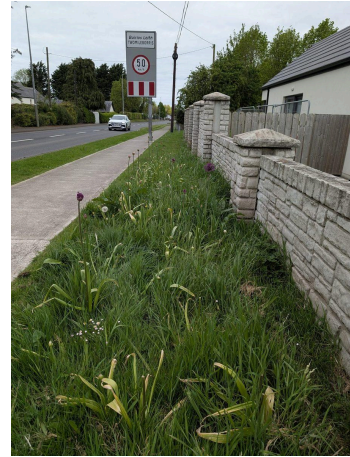


Sections 3, 7 / Project 047 - Alliums along the Glen Carraig limestone wall, May 2026

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Section 3 - Wildflowers on the gravel at the village seating area, May 2026



Sections 3, 7 / Project 047 - Alliums in the Leighton Manor wildflower strip, May 2026

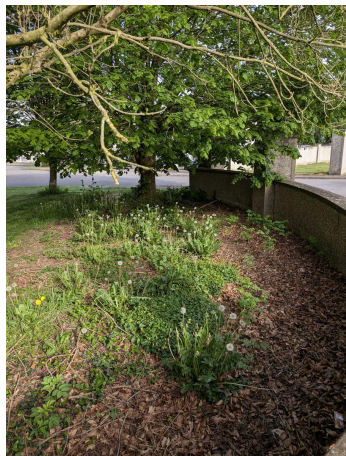


Sections 3, 7 - Leighton Manor roadside wildflower strip, May 2026



Sections 2, 3 - Wildflower strip on the main road at the monument area, May 2026

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Section 7 - Wildflower border at Castle Park, May 2026



Section 4 - Bluebells and nettles in the Old Road Triangle, deliberate non-intervention area, May 2026



Sections 1, 6 / rec #12 - Committee volunteers in hi-vis on the N75 approach during the April 2026 clean-up programme



Sections 5, 6 / rec #12 - April 2026 clean-up haul, the first run of the point-of-collection segregation pilot

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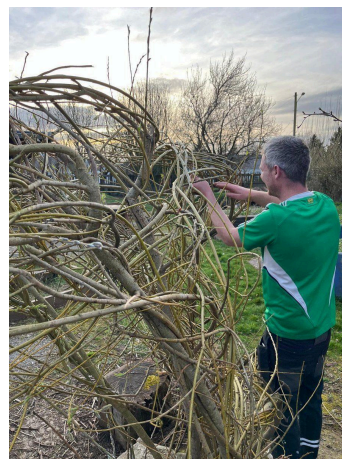
Sections 1, 6 - Trailer collection of bagged waste at the end of an April 2026 clean-up evening



Sections 1, 6 - Volunteers working a hedgerow stretch on a 2026 village litter pick



Section 1 / rec #12 - April Community Litter Pick flyer, pushed out across Parents Association comms, residents-association chats, Instagram and email

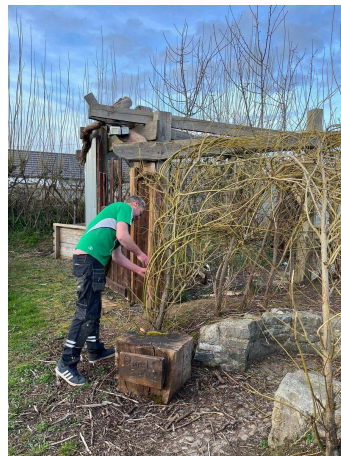


Section 3 / Project 048 - Patrick H weaving the Sensory Garden's living-willow gateway, March 2026

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Section 3 / Project 018 - Sensory Garden timber pergola, freshly oiled in the spring 2026 maintenance blitz



Section 3 / Project 048 - Living-willow gateway at the Sensory Garden, freshly rewoven in spring 2026



Section 3 - Volunteer-built wooden throne in the Sensory Garden, April 2026



Sections 3, 4 / rec #7 - Sensory Garden in daily use as the school's outdoor classroom

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Section 1 - Joan's Wellie Walk and Auction, St Stephen's Day 2025, in memory of committee member Joan O'Dwyer; takings go to the Christmas Lights Committee



Sections 1, 4 / Project 028 - Annual St Bridget's Day Clover Bog Walk, February 2026 (EUR1,000 of the 2025 takings went to the graveyard development)

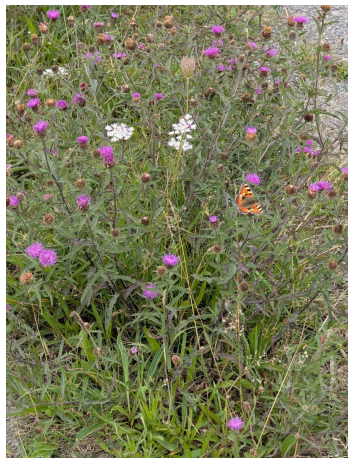


Section 4 / Project 028 - Red Squirrel on the Bog Walk path, summer 2025 (the headline species)



Section 4 / Project 028 - Bog cotton habitat on the Bog Walk Loop, summer 2024

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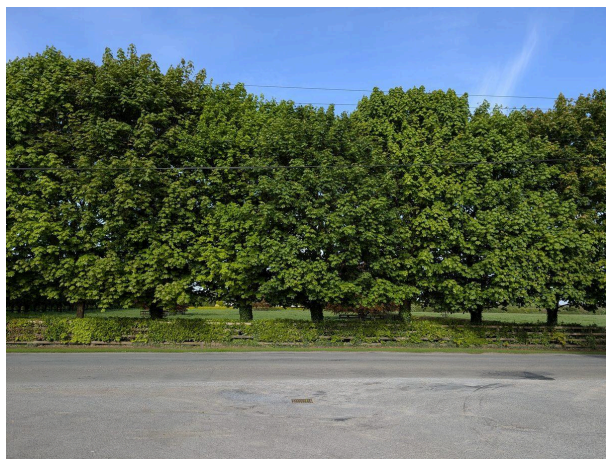
Section 4 / Project 028 - Small Tortoiseshell on Knapweed, Bog Walk wet meadow, summer 2025



Section 4 / Project 045 - Bug hotel in the St James Church grounds, the existing biodiversity feature



Section 2 / Project 022 / rec #2 - The forge, replica window subject for Heritage Officer outreach



Section 8 - Mature deciduous tree avenue framing the Ballyduff Road approach

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Section 6 / Project 005 / rec #13 - Mutt-mitt dispenser at the monument, back on the volunteer round



Section 5 / Project 010 / rec #10 - Cast-iron downpipe at St James Church, candidate water-butt site (TRPS840, Heritage Officer sign-off pending)



Sections 2, 7 / Project 012 - Seamus-built blue trough planter in full summer flower at Meadow Brook



Section 7 - Flowering Hawthorn anchoring the entrance to Fanning Park, May 2026

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*Section 8 - Native Willow and Alder corridor along the Black River,
N75 south approach*



*Section 4 - Old Road Triangle under the canopy, deliberate
non-intervention biodiversity strategy*